

ESL Offline Speaking Games

8 projector games · 960 original English prompts · A1–A2 and B1–B2

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Before class. Unzip the pack, double-click START-HERE.html and open each game once on the classroom computer. Press F for full screen on the projector. The games work with no internet connection.

Honest note. All built-in prompts are in English. There are no Chinese, Japanese or Korean translations inside, but your own prompts can be in any language.

Level note. The built-in prompts cover A1–A2 and B1–B2 for school classes and general adult classes. A1–A2 includes school-life topics (school subjects, homework). There is no C1 level and the prompts avoid sensitive topics; for advanced adult discussion, paste your own prompts.



GAME 01 · [games/01-question-roulette.html](https://www.esl-games.com/games/01-question-roulette.html)

Question Roulette

Level: A1–B2 (choose level and topics)

Players: Whole class, pairs or teams

Time: 5–20 min

Built-in: 300 questions · 15 topics

How to play

1. Open Prompts and choose a level (A1–A2, B1–B2 or All) and the topics you want.
2. Press Spin or Space. The card spins and stops on a question.
3. Name a student, pair or team to answer. Press T to start the answer timer (30 / 60 / 90 s or Off).
4. Use Back to show the previous question again. Questions do not repeat until all are used.

Two classroom variations

Hot seat. One student sits at the front and answers three spins in a row; classmates ask one follow-up question each.

Pair rotation. Spin once, all pairs discuss for 60 seconds, then one partner moves to a new pair before the next spin.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Spin: next question
T	Start / pause the answer timer
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: One question per line. · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

What did you do last weekend?



GAME 02 · games/02-would-you-rather.html

Would You Rather

Level: A1–B2

Players: Whole class (vote) + speakers

Time: 5–15 min

Built-in: 120 questions

How to play

1. Press Next or Space to show option A (orange ▲, left) and option B (blue ●, right).
2. Students raise hands. Count the votes with +1 / –1 under each side (or keys 1 and 2). The bars show percentages.
3. Ask one student from each side for a reason. Press T to start the reason timer (default 30 s).
4. Votes clear on the next question.

Two classroom variations

Walk the line. Students move to the left or right wall of the room instead of raising hands.

Change my mind. Each side has 30 seconds to persuade one person from the other side to move.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Next question
T	Start / pause the reason timer
1	+1 vote for option A
2	+1 vote for option B
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: option A | option B · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

live by the sea | live in the mountains



GAME 03 · games/03-talk-for-30.html

Talk for 30

Level: A1–B2

Players: One speaker at a time; class listens

Time: 10–20 min

Built-in: 120 topics

How to play

1. Press Next topic or Space and choose 30, 60 or 90 seconds.
2. The speaker presses Start (or T) and talks about the topic without stopping.
3. When the speaker hesitates, repeats an idea or goes off topic, press the matching counter (H, R, O).
4. When time is up (or you press End turn), the screen shows how long they spoke and the three counts.

Two classroom variations

Challenge mode. Like the radio game "Just a Minute": a listener who spots a hesitation can take over the topic for the rest of the time.

Pair practice. All pairs talk at the same time to the projected topic; the timer is shared.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Next topic
T	Start / pause the talk timer
H	Hesitation +1
R	Repetition +1
O	Off-topic +1
E	End the turn and show the result
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: One topic per line. · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

Your favourite place in your town



Describe It

Level: A1–B2

Players: 2–6 teams

Time: 15–25 min

Built-in: 150 word cards

How to play

1. Make 2–6 teams in the team strip, rename them, and click the team that plays first. Choose 30–120 seconds (default 60).
2. The word is on the big screen, so guessers must not see it. The describer faces the screen; the rest of the team turns their backs to it. Hot seat option: one guesser sits facing away and the whole team describes. Press Start round or Space.
3. The describer explains the big word without saying it or any red word under DON'T SAY. It works like the party game Taboo.
4. Got it (J) = +1 and next card; Skip (K) = next card; Buzz (B) = a red word was said, –1. At the end the screen lists correct and skipped words. Press Next team.

Two classroom variations

Silent teacher. The describer may only use gestures for the first 10 seconds of each card.

Word bank review. Paste this unit's vocabulary as your own cards before the test.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Start the round / next card (counts as Skip)
T	Pause / resume the round timer
J	Got it: +1 point
K	Skip
B	Buzz: –1 point
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: target word | forbidden 1, forbidden 2, forbidden 3 · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

umbrella | rain, wet, open



GAME 05 · [games/05-odd-one-out.html](https://www.esl-games.com/games/05-odd-one-out.html)

Odd One Out

Level: A1–B2

Players: Teams or pairs

Time: 5–15 min

Built-in: 60 word sets

How to play

1. Press Next or Space to show 4 words. Each tile has its own shape and colour (▲ • ■ ◆).
2. Teams decide which word does not belong and why. Press T to start the think time.
3. Each team says its answer and a reason ("The odd one is ▲ because...").
4. Press Reveal (R): the odd tile lights up and a sample reason appears. Give points; accept other answers with a good reason.

Two classroom variations

Make your own. Teams write a new set of 4 for another team; type the best ones into My prompts.

Reason only. Give the point only for a full-sentence reason.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Next set of 4 words
T	Start / pause the think timer
R	Reveal the odd one and the reason
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: word 1, word 2, word 3, word 4 | odd word | reason (optional) · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

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apple, banana, carrot, grape | carrot | A carrot is a vegetable.
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Agree / Disagree

Level: A1–B2

Players: Whole class

Time: 10–25 min

Built-in: 80 statements

How to play

1. Press Next or Space to show a statement.
2. Students show 1–5 fingers (1 = Strongly disagree, 5 = Strongly agree). Count with +1 / –1 under each column or keys 1–5.
3. Ask students from both ends of the scale to explain. Press T for the discussion timer.
4. Votes clear on the next statement (or press C).

Two classroom variations

Human scale. Students stand along a line in the room from 1 to 5, then talk to the person next to them.

Opinion switch. Students must argue for the opposite number for 30 seconds.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Next statement
T	Start / pause the discussion timer
1 2 3 4 5	+1 vote for that column
C	Clear all votes
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: One statement per line. · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

Homework should be optional.



GAME 07 · games/07-role-play.html

Role Play

Level: A1–B2

Players: Pairs

Time: 10–20 min

Built-in: 40 scenes

How to play

1. Press Next scene or Space. A scene title appears with two task cards: Role A and Role B.
2. Take turns (on by default, key M): both cards start covered. B turns away, press A: only Role A opens; press A to cover it. A turns away, press B: only Role B opens. Take turns off: both cards show at once.
3. Pairs act out the conversation. Press T to start the talk timer (default 2 minutes).
4. Ask one or two pairs to perform, then collect useful phrases on the board.

Two classroom variations

Swap and repeat. Pairs swap roles and play the same scene again with one new detail.

Guess my role. With Take turns on, the class watches the pair perform and guesses what each role card said before you press H to show both.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Next scene
T	Start / pause the talk timer
A	Show / cover Role A (Take turns: A only)
B	Show / cover Role B (Take turns: B only)
H	Cover both / show both
M	Take turns mode on / off
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: scene | Role A task | Role B task · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

At the café | You are a customer. Order a drink. | You work at the café.



GAME 08 · games/08-story-chain.html

Story Chain

Level: A1–B2

Players: 2–30 speakers or teams

Time: 10–20 min

Built-in: 50 openings + 40 word sets

How to play

1. Press New story or Space: a story opening and 3 must-use words appear.
2. Set the number of speakers with – / + and the turn length (10–60 s, default 20).
3. Press Next speaker (N). Each speaker continues the story until the timer ends.
4. Tick each word when it is used (or press 1, 2, 3). When all are used, "All 3 words used!" appears: finish the story.

Two classroom variations

Team chain. Each team adds one sentence; a team that uses a must-use word gets a point.

Write it up. After the round, pairs write the story down in 5 sentences.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	New story: opening + 3 words
T	Start / pause the turn timer
N	Next speaker
1 2 3	Tick word 1, 2 or 3
F	Full screen on / off
Esc	Close the Prompts panel, help or a message
?	Open the in-game help

Use your own prompts

Format: One story opening per line. Lines starting with words: are must-use word sets. · 3–300 per list · lines starting with # are skipped · duplicates are removed.

The lights went out in the middle of dinner.
words: umbrella, cat, birthday

LESSON PLAN

Zero-prep 45-minute speaking lesson

Works for a class of 10–40 students. Set the level once in each game (Prompts → A1–A2 or B1–B2).

Time	Game	What happens
0–8 min	01 Question Roulette	Warm-up. Spin 6–8 questions from 2–3 topics. Pairs answer each one for 60 seconds, then 2 students report what their partner said.
8–18 min	02 Would You Rather	Class votes on 5 questions. After each vote, one student per side gives a reason in 30 seconds. Write useful phrases on the board: <i>I'd rather... because...</i>
18–35 min	04 Describe It	Main activity. 4 teams, 60-second rounds, two rounds per team. The screen lists correct and skipped words after each round: review the skipped words together.
35–43 min	08 Story Chain	Cool-down. One story, 6 speakers, 20 seconds each. The class must use all 3 words before the last speaker.
43–45 min	Exit	Each student says one new word or phrase they used today.

Shorter class? Drop Would You Rather and give Describe It one round per team.

Higher levels? Replace Would You Rather with 06 Agree / Disagree and use B1–B2 everywhere.

Your own prompts, saving and privacy

Adding your own prompts

1. Open Prompts (top bar) in any game.
2. Paste or type your prompts into My prompts using the format shown in that game.
3. Press Use my prompts. The panel tells you how many were found, how many duplicates or # comment lines were skipped, and which line numbers could not be read.
4. Type a name and press Save list. You can keep up to 20 lists per game and load, rename or delete them.

Rules for every game

- Empty lines are ignored; spaces at the start and end are removed.
- Exact duplicate lines are removed; lines starting with # are comments.
- At least 3 prompts are needed to start; if you add more than 300, only the first 300 are used.
- Your prompts can be in any language. Chinese, Japanese and Korean text uses the fonts already on your computer.

Saving and privacy

- Lists are saved only in this browser on this computer (local storage). They are not uploaded and there is no account.
- Each game saves its own lists. A list saved in Describe It does not appear in Role Play.
- To move lists to another computer, use Export .txt and Import .txt.
- The games make no internet connections and use no cookies. Sounds are made by the browser; there are no audio files.

Printing the prompts

The Prompt Bank PDF in the docs folder lists all 960 built-in prompts by game and level, so you can read them aloud in a room without a projector.